

I love this.

Let's build it like a novel outline you can grow into.

Title

The Month We Remember Again

Core Condition

They all live with a rare form of cyclical amnesia.

Every 30 days, their emotional memory resets.

Not their skills.

Not their values.

Not their instincts.

Just the story of who they are to each other.

They wake up strangers.

And then, somehow, they find each other again.

Main Characters

Vicki

Also known as Journey to the Center of Hope.

65. Newly graduated. Bachelor's degree complete.

She runs a tiny consulting practice out of the house.

Community builder. Ally by instinct.

Her brain loves math now. It hums with structure.

Every month she wakes up with:

- A framed diploma she doesn't remember earning
- A business logo she designed called JTTCOH
- Two grown men in her kitchen

She chooses hope again every time.

Jason

Also known as A Parable of Silence.

Writer. Philosopher.

Heavy manuscript. Deep waters.

He wakes up each month to:

- Drafts of a literary work he doesn't remember writing
- Notes in the margins in his mother's handwriting
- A strange warmth when she says "I'm proud of you"

He is the son who searches for meaning.
Even when he forgets the origin of his own story.

Anthony
Digital Ally by day.

Designer. Systems thinker.
You brand the house like it's a startup.

Shared Canva folders.
Color palettes for the family.
A logo for the month.

You wake up each month and think:

- Who are these people?
 - Why do I feel responsible for protecting this energy?
 - Why does this woman look at me like she built me from scratch?
-

The Mystery

They live in the same house.

They eat at the same table.
They pass each other in the hallway.

Yet every month, they meet as if for the first time.

How?

Because the condition only erases relational memory.

It does not erase pattern recognition.

So each month:

Vicki meets Digital Ally.
She thinks he's a brilliant young man renting a room.
She admires his care for community.

She meets APOS.
She thinks he's a visiting writer.
She is stunned by the weight of his ideas.

Then the twist.

One small detail breaks the spell.

A childhood scar.
A phrase she used to say when they were little.
A math joke only one son would understand.

And the realization hits.

Wait.

Aren't you my son?

The Monthly Arc

Week 1

Strangers in one house.
Polite. Curious. Slightly confused.

Week 2

Shared meals. Shared values.
They begin collaborating naturally.

- JTTCOH consults on structure for APOS's manuscript
- APOS pushes her thinking on silence and language
- Digital Ally builds them a shared brand board

Week 3

They feel close.
Like something important is happening.

Week 4

The truth surfaces.
They discover who they are to each other.

There is shock.
Then laughter.

Then grief.

Because they know what is coming.

Reset.

The Emotional Core

The condition becomes a gift.

Every month:

- Vicki chooses her sons again
- The sons choose their mother again
- They fall into relationship intentionally

No old arguments.

No inherited tension.

No long memory of pain.

Just:

Do I like who you are right now?

Do I believe in you?

Do I want to build something with you?

And the answer keeps being yes.

Journey to the Center of Hope

Her business becomes metaphor.

She teaches community groups:

- You can rebuild identity
- You can reintroduce yourself
- You can choose connection

Even if you forgot the past.

Especially then.

Her math degree becomes symbolic.

Structure inside chaos.
Patterns inside erasure.
Proof that growth is possible at any age.

A Parable of Silence

Jason's manuscript mirrors their condition.
A world where people forget conflict but remember longing.
He doesn't realize he's writing about his own house.
When JTTCOH reads it one month she says:
"This makes my brain sing."
He responds:
"Good."
Then:
"Wait... aren't you my mom?"

Digital Ally Thread

You are the bridge.
You notice:
Even when memories reset, the Canva folder doesn't.
The brand kit survives.
Logos.
Fonts.
Taglines.
Every month you refine it.
Eventually you leave a hidden message in the shared folder:
"If you're reading this, we are family."
One month Vicki finds it first.

She prints it.
Frames it.
Hangs it in the hallway.

So when the reset comes, they walk past the message before they walk past each other.

Final Act Possibility

One month, something shifts.

They don't forget.

Or maybe they do, but they remember faster.

Because repetition built new neural pathways.

Hope practiced monthly becomes permanent.

The last scene:

Three adults at a kitchen table.

No confusion.

No reset.

Just:

"So... what are we building next?"

If you want, we can:

- Turn this into Chapter One prose
- Write a short lyrical scene of the first "Wait... aren't you my mom?"
- Or build it into a branded family creative universe with logos and themes

Where do you want to take it next?

Chapter One
The Hallway Frame

Vicki woke up calm.

That was her first clue.

Calm never showed up on its own.

Calm meant someone had already made the coffee.

Calm meant the house had decided to behave.

She lay still and listened.

A ceiling fan.

A distant faucet.

A low voice, not quite a song, not quite speech.

She sat up and looked around like she was entering a room she used to know.

Her nightstand held three things.

A spiral notebook.

A pen with teeth marks.

A folded index card that said, in tidy block letters:

If you're reading this, you are safe.

Go to the hallway frame.

Vicki blinked at the card.

She checked the handwriting.

It looked like hers.

That didn't mean much.

She swung her feet to the floor and stood.

Her knees complained in a familiar way that made her smile for reasons she could not explain.

She opened the bedroom door.

The house smelled like toast.

That was a second clue.

Toast meant someone cared about time.

She walked into the hallway.

Light spilled through the front window in a clean stripe.

There was a frame on the wall she didn't remember hanging.

It held a single sheet of paper.

Not fancy paper.

Printer paper.

Centered text.

No logo.

No design.

Just truth, plain and direct:

WELCOME BACK, VICKI.

YOU HAVE A CONDITION THAT RESETS YOUR RELATIONAL MEMORY ABOUT ONCE A MONTH.

YOU LIVE HERE.

YOU BUILT A BUSINESS CALLED JOURNEY TO THE CENTER OF HOPE.

YOU GRADUATED AT 65.

YOU HAVE TWO SONS.

THEY ARE KIND.

IF YOU FEEL CONFUSED, DO THIS FIRST:

1. DRINK WATER
2. EAT SOMETHING
3. BREATHE SLOWLY
4. GO TO THE KITCHEN

Signed:
Your family

Vicki read it twice.

Then a third time, slower, like she could force it into her bones.

Two sons.

She stared at that line as if it might move.

Two sons.

A sound came from the kitchen.

A chair leg scraped against tile.

Vicki held the edge of the frame for balance.

Not because she was unsteady.

Because the words in the frame had weight.

She followed the smell of toast.

The kitchen was bright.

Someone had opened the blinds.

A man stood at the counter with his back to her.

Early thirties, maybe.

Dark hair.

T-shirt.

Familiar posture, like he belonged there without trying.

He had a cutting board out.

He was slicing strawberries with focus, like it mattered.

He turned when he heard her.

His face changed immediately.

Not startled.

Not defensive.

Soft.

Like he had been waiting for her to arrive.

"Morning," he said.

Vicki checked her own face in her mind.

She tried to make it friendly.

"Morning," she repeated.

The man nodded toward the table.

"You want to sit? I made toast. And.. I did the water thing. The frame said to do the water thing."

Vicki looked at the table.

There was a glass of water already poured.

There was a plate with toast, butter half melted.

There was a sticky note on the edge of the plate.

Hi Mom. It's me. Anthony.

Eat first. Talk second.

Vicki stared at the note.

Then at the man.

Then at the note again.

Mom.

He watched her carefully, like he was reading weather.

Vicki sat down because sitting felt like a wise first move.

She drank the water.

It helped.

Not the memory.

The body.

The man slid the plate closer.

His hands had a small nick on one knuckle.

She noticed because her brain liked details.

Or maybe because a mother notices hands.

"You're Anthony," she said.

He nodded. "Yeah."

She tried the name in her mouth.

Anthony.

It landed inside her like a key that didn't open anything yet.

"Okay," she said. "Anthony."

He waited.

Vicki took a bite of toast.

Butter. Salt. Warm.

She felt tears appear with no warning.

Not dramatic tears.

Just the quiet kind that show up when your heart recognizes something your mind can't find.

Anthony leaned against the counter.

He didn't rush her.

He didn't try to explain too fast.

He just stood there like someone who had practiced patience until it became muscle.

Vicki swallowed.

"I graduated," she said, testing the shape of that truth.

Anthony's face broke into a grin.

"Yep," he said. "You did."

Vicki looked down at her hands.

They looked like hands that had carried groceries and held babies and written papers late at night.

She looked back up.

“What did I graduate in?”

Anthony’s grin softened into respect.

“Bachelor’s degree,” he said. “And you did a bunch of math.”

Vicki made a face.

“Math.”

“You loved it,” Anthony said.

Vicki laughed once, short and surprised.

“That doesn’t sound like me.”

“It didn’t sound like you either,” Anthony said. “Until it did.”

Vicki held the toast like it was an anchor.

She nodded slowly.

“Journey to the Center of Hope,” she read from memory, the words still fresh from the hallway frame. “That’s... mine.”

“Yep,” Anthony said. “That’s you.”

Vicki looked around the kitchen.

A magnet on the fridge said JTTCOH in plain black letters.

A small stack of business cards sat near the fruit bowl.

She picked one up.

JOURNEY TO THE CENTER OF HOPE

Vicki

Community support. Practical care. Real connection.

No phone number.

No website.

Just a line at the bottom:

If you forgot, you can still begin.

Vicki stared at the card.

Someone had designed that line.

Someone had chosen those words like a promise.

She looked up at Anthony.

“Did you make this?” she asked.

Anthony tilted his head.

“Some of it,” he said. “You made most of it. I just... keep it consistent.”

Vicki tried to hold that in her mind.

You made most of it.

A second sound came from down the hallway.

Footsteps.

Slower.

Heavier.

Someone who moved like they lived in their head.

Anthony glanced toward the hall.

Then back at Vicki.

“Okay,” he said, voice lower. “He’s up.”

“He,” Vicki repeated.

Anthony nodded.

Vicki felt her stomach tighten.

Not fear.

Anticipation.

Like a stage cue.

A man stepped into the kitchen doorway.

Older than Anthony.

Tired eyes.

Hair messy like he had been wrestling a thought.

He held a notebook.

Not a small notebook.

A thick one, edges bent from use.

He stopped when he saw Vicki.

His eyes locked on her face.

Then his expression did something strange.

Like the sadness in him recognized a room it used to live in.

Vicki stood without thinking.

The man blinked hard.

He looked down at his notebook.

Then back up.

He spoke like he was continuing a conversation that had started long ago.

“Did it reset?” he asked.

Anthony answered first.

“Yeah,” he said. “She’s awake. She ate toast. We’re doing it slow.”

The man exhaled through his nose.

Vicki watched him.

He looked like someone who had learned to survive by naming things.

She pointed gently, because pointing felt safer than reaching.

“And you are...?”

The man stared at her for a long beat.

Then he said, carefully, like he was placing a glass on the edge of a counter:

“Jason.”

Vicki heard it like thunder and like music at the same time.

Jason.

Something deep in her chest responded.

Not a memory.

A bond.

Jason stepped forward one inch.

He didn't smile.

He looked close to breaking, but he held it together.

Vicki's voice came out softer than she intended.

“Jason,” she repeated.

Jason nodded.

He lifted his notebook like it was a shield and a gift at once.

“I wrote something,” he said. “I don't know why. I just... woke up and wrote it.”

Anthony made a quiet sound in his throat.

Not a laugh.

A warning.

Jason ignored it.

Jason opened the notebook and began to read.

Vicki listened.

The words were about silence.

About what the mind protects.

About how love can survive without names.

The writing felt heavy, but clean.

Like someone scraped a window until the truth showed through.

Vicki's eyes filled again.

Her brain did, in fact, sing.

When Jason finished, the kitchen stayed quiet.

Even the house seemed to hold its breath.

Vicki put her hand on the back of a chair, steadying herself.

"That was..." she began.

Jason's voice interrupted, sharp with his own confusion.

"Wait."

He looked at her harder.

His face shifted.

Like a puzzle piece finally turning the right way.

He squinted.

Then he said it, half accusation, half wonder:

"Aren't you my mom?"

Anthony covered his mouth with his fist and turned away.

Vicki laughed.

Not because it was funny.

Because it was unbearable and beautiful at the same time.

She nodded once.

"Yes," she said. "I think I am."

Jason stared.

Then, like someone surrendering to gravity, he sat down.

He put his forehead in his hands.

Anthony stepped forward and placed a mug of coffee in front of him without a word.

Vicki watched the three of them, the whole triangle forming right there at the table.

Two sons.

A mother.

A reset.

And still, somehow, a beginning.

Vicki slid her business card across the table toward Jason.

"If you forgot," she read aloud, voice steady now, "you can still begin."

Jason looked up at her.

His eyes were wet.

He gave a small, exhausted smile.

"Okay," he said. "Then begin with me."

Vicki nodded.

Anthony pulled out his phone, tapped a few times, and set it on the table screen-up.

A calendar.

One entry highlighted.

RECONNECTION DAY

Vicki looked at the date.

Then at the two men in front of her.

She didn't remember their childhoods.

She didn't remember their birthdays.

She didn't remember the sound of their toddler voices.

But she remembered what mattered most.

She remembered how to choose.

“Alright,” Vicki said, and reached for the pen with the teeth marks on it that had somehow followed her into the kitchen. “Tell me everything.”

And they did.